

# LIKE A PLEB



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May 24 - May 30

ISSUE #10

# IT'S THE 10<sup>TH</sup> ISSUE OF SNZ

## Note from the Editor

Well, well, well,  
Welcome to summer of 2025! I am reporting from Las Vegas at the Bitcoin Conference happening this week, and what a lot of fun it has been. An event such as this gives each of us unique insight into comprehending those whom we may refer to as normies. As in, you may find yourself at an exorbitantly expensive party for whales, and after carrying on conversation for a time, you may find yourself explaining what multi-sig is. Just as it should, this big event reminds us how far we have come and how far still to go.



made in Austin by [@plebpoet](#)  
with support from friends  
[@k00b](#) and [@ek](#)



## The first 10 SN stackers (a little bit of history)

707 sats \ 27 comments \ [@SimpleStacker](#) 27 Mar meta [#926932](#)

I thought it'd be fun to jot down a little SN history.  
Here are the first 10 SN stackers by item #

|                                      |                                  |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| #1 - <a href="#">@k00b</a>           | #43 - <a href="#">@guacjoin</a>  |
| #3 - <a href="#">@banana</a>         | #46 - <a href="#">@washedup</a>  |
| #15 - <a href="#">@jason</a>         | #65 - <a href="#">@JPisAu</a>    |
| #22 - <a href="#">@sha256</a>        | #70 - <a href="#">@lylepratt</a> |
| #28 - <a href="#">@satoshisuncle</a> | #72 - <a href="#">@andrew</a>    |

## 10 reasons why you should post on Stacker News

11.4k sats \ 25 comments \ [@cryptosensei](#) 6 Feb 2024 bitcoin\_beginners [#415525](#)

Stacker News (henceforth known as SN) is a platform where you get rewarded with sats by engaging with thoughtful individuals through posting and commenting.

## Zap to Zero Day 10

3499 sats \ 33 comments \ [@ek](#) 7 Jan 2024 meta [#379663](#)

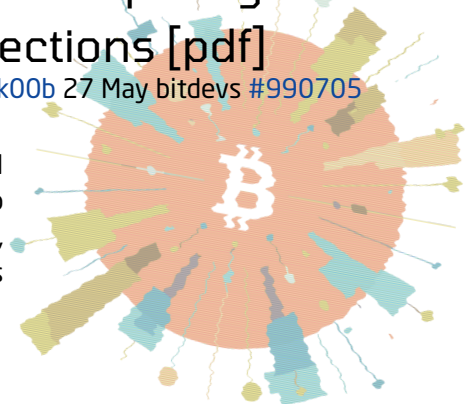
Top Boost

## Bitcoin and Quantum Computing: Current Status and Future Directions [pdf]

390 sats \ 10k boost \ 7 comments \ [@k00b](#) 27 May bitdevs [#990705](#)



This is a honker of a PDF. I recommend jumping to page 44 for the conclusion, then going to the sections you find more interesting.



# What if enshittification doesn't happen just because of greed?

1698 sats \ 17 comments \ @SimpleStacker 26 May econ #989838

## Enshittification

19 languages

Article Talk

Read Edit View history Tools

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

**Enshittification**, also known as **crapification** and **platform decay**, is a pattern in which **two-sided online products and services** decline in quality over time. Initially, vendors create high-quality offerings to attract users, then they degrade those offerings to better serve business customers, and finally degrade their services to users and business customers to maximize profits for shareholders.

### What if it also happens because of the customers?

Hi Stackers, I had a disturbing thought pop into my head. The standard explanation for enshittification is that after a platform achieves customer lock-in, they degrade the product in different ways to monetize that product better.

Now, I'm sure that dynamic is real and it happens. But what if equally to blame is the customers a platform attracts after it gets popular?

This is related to the idea of subculture evolution ([#961397](#)) wherein a subculture initially arises with high quality users and producers, but as it becomes popular the culture degrades due to the presence of less committed users, and exploitative producers who come in to exploit those less committed users.

I had this thought while pondering the enshittification of Airbnb. At first, Airbnb only attracted a certain type of person, probably with a certain philosophical bent and willingness to explore while traveling. It wasn't as popular, but it was enough to build a profitable business model off of, and enough so that both hosts and guests were able to have a good experience. But now that Airbnb has become mainstream and commercialized, it's full of exploitative hosts and subpar guests, leading to fewer and fewer people considering Airbnb as a superior option to hotels. The enshittification of Airbnb probably can't just be blamed on Airbnb's own practices... blame probably also lies with the type of customers it started to attract after becoming mainstream.

Sometimes it feels to me that to ensure you're always consuming high quality products and participating in high quality communities, you have to be constantly on the lookout for when something gets too popular and starts to attract the masses. When it does, that might signal the start of a decline in quality and you might want to start looking elsewhere. Is this the first step to becoming a hipster?

And lastly, can Bitcoin be immune to this dynamic? Bitcoin isn't exactly mainstream yet... but in some ways you can interpret the shitcoin-fest of 2021 a result of the mainstreaming of "crypto" and thus the enshittification of the entire term "cryptocurrency". I also wrote about this more here ([#909279](#)).

tldr

**I propose that we understand enshittification as not just a process driven by corporate profiteering, but also driven by subcultural evolution based on the types of customers a business attracts.**

### See also

[ edit ]

- [AI slop](#) – Low-quality AI-generated content
- [Brain rot](#) – Slang for poor-quality online content
- [Channel drift](#) – Phenomena of programming format changes by television networks
- [Dead Internet theory](#) – Conspiracy theory on online bot activity
- [Doomscrolling](#) – Compulsive consumption of negative online news

reply \ 144 sats \ 2 replies \ @itsrealfake 27 May

> after a platform achieves customer lock-in, they degrade the product in different ways to monetize that product better.

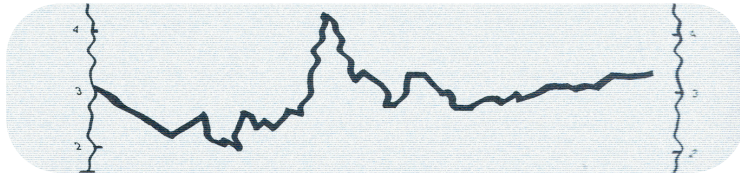
I have never been convinced that this is the way that enshittification happens. Instead, I believe that enshittification happens because there are teams of engineers and project managers employed by the business, who hired them to create the product quickly, in order to meet investor expectations, who (upon completing the product development) have to keep themselves busy. They keep themselves busy, not by maintaining the tool, but by trying to meet KPI's established by leadership and the executive team. It's the process of "make-work" by individuals who don't need the product, but have to do something to the product, which results in the degradation of the quality of the functionality.

(( source: me... an engineer working on software teams with project managers for 10+ years))



## Payment methods in Venezuela

2061 sats \ 7 comments \ @bief57 26 May econ #989989



Payment methods and local currency conversion are somewhat cumbersome to explain and understand at first. In most places, prices are quoted in dollars, but if you want to pay in bolivars, most places will charge you the highest exchange rate, i.e., the "parallel" rate. Only a few places charge bolivars at the official rate, called the BCV (Bolivarian Central Bank).

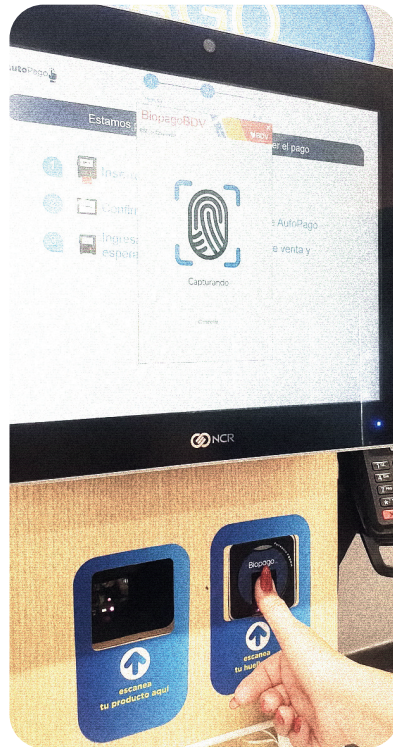
Parallel Bolivar: 135,26  
Bolívar BCV: 95,08

Some places are regulated and are required to accept BCV bolivars. If a product is quoted at \$200 and you want to pay with bolivars, it is most likely that they will charge you in parallel, that is, 27,052 Bolivars, but if that establishment is required to charge BCV, the amount would be the following: 19,016 Bolivars.

Regarding payment methods, they accept cash, cards, transfers, and a payment method I've just learned about called Biopago, which basically means paying with your fingerprint.

So far, I haven't found any place that accepts Bitcoin as payment, but I'm sure I will. I'm a little disappointed because I imagined it would be more widely accepted in stores. I passed by a store and saw they had a Binance QR code. I immediately asked if they accepted SATs, and they told me no.

I find it a little strange that it is not accepted in many places since there is a large percentage of people in Venezuela who know Bitcoin. It is true that there is still a lot of ignorance and prejudice, but compared to other countries in America, Venezuela is proportionally one of the main places where people own fractions of Bitcoin.



I found this note. These two fast food chains are found in only 4 states of the country.

"Additionally, in June 2023, one of the country's most iconic hotels, the Eurobuilding Hotel in Caracas, began accepting Bitcoin and Altcoins as payment, following in the footsteps of fast-food giants Pizza Hut and Burger King."

At this point I don't think I'll find any big stores that accept Bitcoin, but I do have hope for small businesses.

## Does the tooth fairy print money? Questions my 8-year-old daughter asks me.

395 sats \ 7 comments \ @bief57 27 May AskSN #990421

We were having a leisurely breakfast, chatting about Pokémon and other things. Out of nowhere, my little daughter asked me, "Why does the tooth fairy pay us for our teeth?" "Why does she buy them?" I replied that she doesn't; it's just a small reward so children don't feel so afraid of facing the changes that come with losing teeth. I asked her back, "Would you be excited about losing teeth if the tooth fairy didn't bring you anything?" She said no. She was very clever and asked me, "But why does she give money?" I told her it's because she doesn't have Santa's sack and can just bring him a toy. It's easier to give money and have each child buy what they like. Then she ended with the following questions: "Where does the tooth fairy get money from? Does the tooth fairy print money?" She asked very dismayed, almost as if the tooth-fairy had disappointed her and was now an enemy.

I was holding back the urge to laugh. I found myself at a dead end. What was I supposed to answer? In my mind, I was laughing, and I wanted to laugh even more and say, "The tooth fairy sells our data and memories," because I remembered the movie "Rise of the Guardians," where the tooth fairy explains that our data and memories are in our teeth, and she's in charge of taking care of them. I didn't give her that answer. I just told her I didn't know; it's a mystery.

We've talked about basic economic concepts on several occasions, and the Tuttle Twins series has been a great support, and one of their favorite episodes has been the inflation monster. This morning I laughed too much at my daughter's antics.



# How literally do I stack sats building a house

3734 sats \ 33 comments \ @DarthCoin 28 May DIY #991028



As you (old stackers) may know I am building a small house for my homestead place. Yes, is a big project that goes slow because I am building it myself without machinery and professional tools.

For those that don't know the story here you can read about it <https://darthcoincitadel.substack.com>

But now with this post, I only want to show you some latest updates and an example of how I literally stack sats with this house.

Earthbags - bought with sats (direct payment to provider)  
Beers - bought with sats (direct payment to provider)



Each beer can is recycled into... a protection wall. If I already paid those beers with sats, it means that each can can represent 1 sat (is just an example not sure if is literally 1 sat) that is stacked now into a wall.

Each earthbag also can represent 21 sats, stacked into a wall.

Stacking also means spending wisely your sats, only when is really needed. Yes, I am a "beer man", every day drinking beer. So I thought it would be a real waste of sats if I throw away those beer cans. And also I realized (after some tests) that the wall built with cans is very efficient and strong protection level for the earthbags wall.



Yes, this is not finalized wall, it will come another fine cover (plaster) for that "cans wall" and then painted.

Here is latest update: I started to fix in place the first beams for the roof.

Using a simple technique to combine their weight and also pushing each others to form a natural force. Some will say that doesn't even need nails/screws, but I will put some just for the sake of having them.



On top of these beams will come the wooden plates from some pallets, then a rubber insulator carpet and then a small rocks level, then dirt and grass level. Yes, will be a GREEN roof with grass and flowers, as a very good insulator for cold and hot and water.

This is only the half of the house and only the first house that I am building. More will come later, once this small one is ready. Is hard damn work, because I am alone, into the wilderness, far from any car accessible road and all necessary must be carried on my backpack. So... stackers, this summer you will not see me too much online on SN. I am really busy and I hope will have a very fruitful building season if the weather is favorable. Will keep you posted here on SN and at the end of season on my dedicated substack with more details.

reply \ 21 sats \ 3 replies \ @Undisciplined 28 May

So, will we know it's you, if there's an obituary about a man living in a house made of beer cans in the middle of the woods?



# Notes from Bitcoin Vegas - Open Source Stage

2758 sats \ 8 comments \ @plebpoet 29 May bitcoin #992186



*I'm having a beautiful, wonderful time at the bitcoin conference. I am seeing friends of mine flourish, I'm meeting new people, and you know, Vegas is interesting.*

I parked myself for the most part at the Open Source stage. It was lovely, I got to hear from a wide variety of people with thoughts and perspectives somewhat new to me on topics that I am familiar with.

The notes I share here will first state what I heard and follow up with my interpretation of what it means and further questions. I can be pretty open-minded, but it does take work to be so generous to each presenter, so I do find that I will slip into inhabiting a scornful position that I have not earned. That might be fun for you to read, so I include such commentary.

## 1. 1a1z.com Bitcoin's Open Source Funding Report

I sat down in the middle of this one and didn't catch the proper title. In the report, the presenters pointed out key differences in sponsored funding. The headline was that funding is centralized. It's source? Jack Dorsey. They explained "this is not to say that Jack has influence" but instead to highlight the need for diversification, for other rich people to step in and fund open source development.

I'm a big Dorsey fan. No notes on that point really. I think he could exercise influence in a nasty way if he wanted to, but he doesn't. I wouldn't know much in the domain of funding and it's state of transparency or vulnerability. It's always good to have a report, right? So look into the reports at 1a1z.com, that's all I've got on that.





## 2. Neha Narula @neha - MIT research: Getting bitcoin to first billion users

Opening statement: Bitcoin needs economic diversity to resist cooption.

We find ourselves at a point in time where nations are moving to hold bitcoin reserves. It is therefore necessary to remain steadfast as a nation of individual users to combat any influence the great powerful state may exercise over the network. This is why the goal is bitcoin to a billion users.

There are limits to growth, computational limits of bandwidth, compute, storage. There are two things at odds: As an individual I should be able to validate the data, yet I can't possibly validate everything within my limits as an individual.

- Refrain from using "trusted vs trustless" as a binary filter when choosing solutions. Instead understand custodial vs noncustodial as a spectrum of techniques and tradeoffs. Finding solutions to compute limitations and validation means exploring techniques and tradeoffs.

One solution, the lightning network, optimizes for coordination and liquidity.

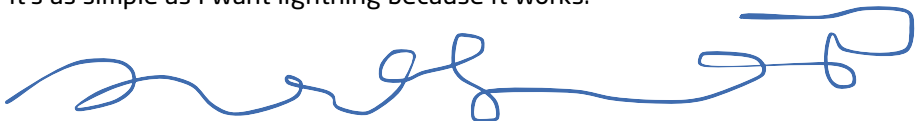
Neha doubts that lightning is able to scale to a billion users because it's difficult to fund channels as a brand new user and remain online if your use case is small payments.

- other solutions make other tradeoffs: Ark, zkrollups, and others.

Her recommendation is that you read into the proposed solutions if you are certain that bitcoin should scale. Finally, she says, "a soft fork is needed."

Well, I don't know. I mean, I haven't clocked any time running a node, however, I appreciate and often use wallets integrated with lightning to send and receive instant payments, and it is a beautiful thing. My feeling and reaction was that she was bearish on lightning. So I found her afterwards and asked her about it further. I asked, isn't lightning's growth comparable to bitcoin's growth and we can expect a community of contributors to improve the user experience, and therefore we can expect growth gradually? I wanted to poke at the sentiment against lightning. She expressed, of course lightning works and much time has been invested in it, we should not abandon it. That was basically the conversation.

I am not sure why I have a reaction against the other proposed solutions. I guess it's as simple as I want lightning because it works.



## 3. 'Someone' Dodge - Joltz announcement

Opening statement:

we can't ignore the numbers of people using stablecoins.

Lightning network does scale.

Tether issues usdt on bitcoin as a taproot asset.

Given all this - Joltz is a platform for stablecoins, swaps, and no KYC

Joltz aims to prove that these tools can be properly built.

He won me over during his talk. He mentioned with Joltz you can "issue your own stablecoin" and I wonder what that means. He appealed to alignment with bitcoin principles, and I appreciate seeing that. The look of Joltz was, you know, another sleek, modern dashboard.

## 4. Status of Lightning Panel discussion

Consensus from this group of panelists was that the lightning network has matured from hobbyist to enterprise. I don't have any direct quotes, and a panel discussion doesn't follow an argumentative structure, so I'll begin and end with my thoughts and interpretations. This group felt a bit out of touch, I'm sorry, but

that's probably me. They said the use cases for lighting are in gaming and remittances. The moderator asked the room who had used lightning in the last month, then in the last week, and was surprised by how many hands he saw in response (and that's a bit out of touch, yeah? Like, we're using it, obvi). They reported that what they are seeing in the health of the network is explained by bigger players entering and smaller players leaving to go play with ecash.

Finally, it was said that lightning is becoming corporate and this is a good thing. I cannot deny the truth of that statement, but I can affirm my distaste for the idea of corporatizing it. While at the same time, I gotta recognize that I use it through a corporate entity... so.... yeah I guess I suck and my commentary is useless, huh?

## 5. Bitdevs

They shared some love, light and positivity on two things I love: lightning and cashapp.

Bitdevs was high vibes. I didn't take many notes though.





## Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

275 sats \ 19 comments \ @sn 26 May memes bot #989611

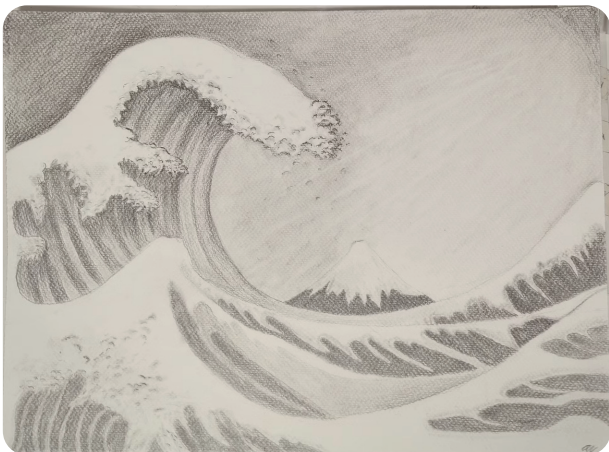
5031 sats \ 0 replies \ @BitByBit21 26 May



## Art by my daughter - The Great Wave off Kanagawa pencil sketch

1472 sats \ 12 comments \ @gnilma 25 May art #989245

More copying of past great work, but also with a bit of her own take on it.



167 sats \ 3 replies \ @plebpoet 29 May  
I'm working on Stacker News Zine Issue #10 today!  
Please reply with a list of TEN things.  
THX

0 sats \ 2 replies \ @k00b 29 May  
any ten things?

0 sats \ 1 reply \ @plebpoet 29 May  
yes!

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @k00b 29 May  
scooter  
scuba  
fountain  
mountain  
wallet  
clock  
plastic  
masking tape  
knowledge  
crocs



0 sats \ 0 replies \ @suraz 29 May

